

Pooja Balasubramanian

Feminist heterodox researcher, writer and artist

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CONTACT

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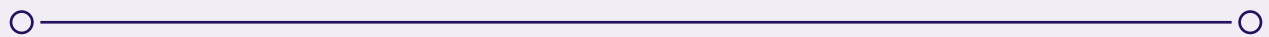
EDUCATION

2016–2020 PhD, Development Economics
University of Göttingen

2014–2015 MSc Social Policy Analysis
KU Leuven, LISER

2012–2013 MSc Development Economics
SOAS University of London

2009–2012 BA Economics (Hons)
St. Xavier's College, University of Mumbai



Career

2025–Present
Independent Researcher, Writer & Lecturer, Filmmaker

2020–2024
Senior Researcher · German Institute of Development and Sustainability (IDOS), Germany

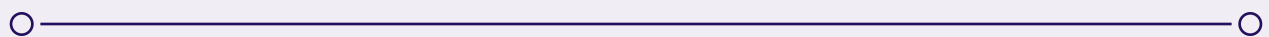
2022–2023
Lecturer / Seminar Instructor (Masters) · University of Duisburg-Essen & Exploring Economics Summer School

2017–2020
Teaching (Masters) · University of Göttingen

2016–2017
Consultant · Centre for Global Development, United Nations Foundation

2014–2015
Researcher · Luxembourg Institute of Socio-Economic Research

2013–2014
Research Associate · Jameel Poverty Action Lab



ADDITIONAL ENGAGEMENT

Freelance theatre artist and collaborator with feminist theatre collectives (Germany/India), with an interest in public engagement and creative pedagogy.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

MS Office · Google Suite · DaVinci Resolve · Claude · STATA · R · LaTeX



Publications

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Balasubramanian, P. (forthcoming). From peripheral populations to financial fiefdoms: A case study from southern India. *Economic and Political Weekly*.

[Balasubramanian, P., Ibanez, M., Khan, S., & Sahoo, S. \(2024\). Does women's economic empowerment promote human development in low- and middle-income countries? A meta-analysis. *World Development*, 187, Article 106588.](#)

[Balasubramanian, P., Burchi, F., & Malerba, D. \(2023\). Does economic growth reduce multidimensional poverty? Evidence from low- and middle-income countries. *World Development*, 161, Article 106119.](#)

[Breuer, A., Malerba, D., Srigiri, S., & Balasubramanian, P. \(2022\). Governing the interlinkages between the SDGs: Approaches, opportunities and challenges \(Introduction\). In *Governing the interlinkages between the SDGs: Approaches, opportunities and challenges*. Routledge.](#)

[Balasubramanian, P. \(2022\). Poverty, inequality and growth: The East Asian experience. In A. Breuer, D. Malerba, S. Srigiri, & P. Balasubramanian \(Eds.\), *Governing the interlinkages between the SDGs: Approaches, opportunities and challenges* \(pp. 192–210\). Routledge.](#)

NON-PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

[Balasubramanian, P. \(2020\). Subjective returns to education: Rational expectations of disadvantaged groups in India \(UNU-WIDER Working Paper No. 144\). UNU-WIDER.](#)

POLICY & PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

[Balasubramanian, P. \(2025\). As the ideal German immigrant, I saw how the supremacist integration system enables the far right. *Scroll.in*.](#)

[Balasubramanian, P., & Sengupta, T. \(2024\). Speculative money has been turning millions of people into commodities. *The Wire*.](#)

[Balasubramanian, P. \(2024\). 80 years of bleeding us dry! The Bretton Woods Institutions, austerity, and social protection. In *Towards a People's History of the IMF & World Bank: Critical Articles Amid 80 Years of Neocolonial Plunder* \(pp. 32–37\). IBON International.](#)

Asimeng, T., & Balasubramanian, P. (2024). Why transportation should work for women in Africa. *The Current Column*, German Institute of Development and Sustainability (IDOS), 6 March 2024.

[Balasubramanian, P. \(2021\). Debt in everyday life: A critique on the increasing role of finance in social policy. *The Current Column*, German Development Institute \(DIE\), 15 December 2021.](#)

Adhikari, A., Aggarwal, A., Balu, Bahl, M., & Balasubramanian, P. (2011). Food entitlements. *Economic & Political Weekly*, 46(30), Letters.